

Applied Cognition Note 3: Working-Memory Load

Due: Tuesday, September 29 at 11:59 PM Value: 15 points Format: 500-700 word analysis

Purpose

Document how concurrent demands change performance and use a working-memory model to explain the pattern.

Your task

- Complete the same five-minute planning task under two conditions: quiet and while retaining an eight-character sequence. Counterbalance the order with a partner if possible.
- Record completion time, number of omissions, sequence recall, and a brief strategy note for both conditions.
- Interpret the difference using central executive control and at least one component store.
- Propose one task redesign that reduces unnecessary load while preserving the task's actual difficulty.

Submit

- One PDF with a two-condition results table and 500-700 word analysis.

Important note

Use only your own performance data. The task is a classroom demonstration, not a diagnostic assessment.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Accurate concept	4	Uses the assigned cognitive concept accurately and precisely.
Concrete evidence	4	Documents specific observations or examples rather than general impressions.
Analysis	5	Connects evidence to a defensible explanation and acknowledges a limitation.
Clarity and attribution	2	Meets length, organization, and citation expectations.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.